

RELOCATION GUIDE

Geelong

Wadawurrung Country

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Geelong.

A bay city by the coast. Melbourne an hour away.

Geelong is Victoria's second city, built around the calm blue curve of Corio Bay, with the only tertiary hospital in the state outside Melbourne and the Great Ocean Road beginning just down the road. It gives clinicians genuine tertiary work, a commute measured in minutes and a coastline that becomes part of an ordinary week, with Melbourne an easy hour away whenever you want it.

~295,000

people in Greater Geelong

1 hr

to Melbourne by train or freeway

25 min

to Torquay and the Great Ocean Road

The only

tertiary hospital in Victoria outside Melbourne

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Geelong

Most people who move here are choosing a hospital they can genuinely get to know, a coastline at the end of the street, and Melbourne close enough to enjoy without living in it.



If you're looking for the scale and buzz of a city of five million, Geelong may not be it. But if you're drawn to tertiary-level work, a short commute and the beach on a Tuesday evening, it could be a wonderful choice.

Geelong sits on Corio Bay about 75 kilometres south-west of Melbourne. It grew wealthy on wool in the nineteenth century, became one of Victoria's great manufacturing centres in the twentieth, and over the last fifteen years has reinvented itself around health, education and the public sector. Today it is a relaxed, confident city of around 295,000 people with a rebuilt waterfront, a lively café strip and two university campuses.

For clinicians the proposition is specific. The region's principal referral hospital is the only tertiary hospital in Victoria based outside metropolitan Melbourne, serving a primary catchment of around 350,000 people and more for some specialist services. That means a case mix much closer to a metropolitan teaching hospital than a typical regional posting, in a city where most suburbs are ten to twenty minutes from work.

Geelong is also classed as **regional** for skilled-migration purposes, which can open pathways that Melbourne itself does not offer. It is worth asking a registered migration agent how that applies to your situation.

WHAT YOU GAIN

Tertiary work, regional pace

Genuine case complexity and subspecialty exposure, with a commute that rarely tops twenty minutes.

Seniority sooner

Specialist teams are smaller than in a Melbourne teaching hospital, so your voice and your name are on decisions earlier.

Room to live

Housing costs noticeably less than Melbourne, so a family home with a garden is a realistic goal.

The coast as an everyday thing

The Bellarine Peninsula and the start of the Great Ocean Road sit inside your weekday radius, not just your holidays.

GOOD TO KNOW

A close-knit specialist bench

Your specialty will be a team rather than a large department. Ask at interview how many colleagues sit alongside you.

Melbourne for the rarest cases

A small number of highly specialised cases go to Melbourne services an hour away; most work is managed locally.

A breezy city

Geelong catches the wind off the bay and Bass Strait. Locals keep a jacket in the car and a backup plan for the beach.

Busy summer beaches

From Boxing Day to late January, half of Melbourne heads for the Bellarine and Surf Coast. Locals simply go early.



The Geelong waterfront from above: the city turned to face the water again

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Weighing up your options?

People often compare Geelong with Melbourne, an hour away, for its depth of subspecialty teams; with Newcastle or the Gold Coast, for a similar coastal second-city lifestyle; and with smaller regional Victorian cities for even more space. Geelong usually offers the best balance of tertiary work, coast and access to a capital. We are always happy to talk any of them through.



The Great Ocean Road coast near the Twelve Apostles: a long day out, or a lovely overnight, from Geelong



Long weekend brunches are a favourite local ritual



Surfing is a lifelong pastime for many Australians

Geelong at a glance

Geelong is easiest to understand as a bay city that has turned to face the water again. The waterfront, the breeze and the way the suburbs spread all follow from Corio Bay.

The city centre sits on the southern shore of Corio Bay, the western arm of Port Phillip. The Barwon River winds through the southern suburbs before reaching the sea at Barwon Heads, the Bellarine Peninsula stretches away to the east, and the granite peaks of the You Yangs rise on the skyline to the north. The surf coast begins at Torquay, twenty-five minutes south.

In practice, the inner suburbs and the waterfront are compact and easy to walk, the newest housing is growing south towards Armstrong Creek, and the Bellarine towns give you beach life with a short drive into work.

75 km

south-west of Melbourne

~22%

of residents born overseas

the UK, India, New Zealand
and the Philippines lead
the list

2

Deakin University
campuses

one built into the
waterfront

Summer

DEC – FEB

Warm to hot, with long light evenings on the bay. A hot northerly is often followed by a refreshing cool change off the water within hours.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Mild and settled, with still days, warm water and golden light on the waterfront. Many locals' favourite season.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Cool and fresh, with crisp sunny days between Bass Strait weather fronts. A good coat and a cosy café are the local answer.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Changeable and breezy, with wildflowers on the You Yangs, lambs in the paddocks and the first warm beach days.



Wadawurrung Country

TENS OF THOUSANDS OF YEARS

Corio Bay and the surrounding plains have been cared for by the Wadawurrung people, one of the five nations of the Kulin alliance.



A port on the bay

1830S

European settlement followed the sheltered anchorage, shipping wool from the Western District.



The wool boom

19TH CENTURY

Wool wealth built the grand civic architecture that still graces the city centre.



A manufacturing city

20TH CENTURY

Car making, aluminium and an oil refinery made Geelong one of Victoria's industrial hearts.



Back to the water

TODAY

A rebuilt waterfront, state agency head offices, a growing university and health sector, and a city looking firmly forward.



A note on Country

Geelong sits on the land of the Wadawurrung people, whose Traditional Owner organisation is the Wadawurrung Traditional Owners Aboriginal Corporation. Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings and events across the region, and you will soon hear it at work too.



Corio Bay, the water the whole city is built around



Wool-boom grandeur in the city centre



Johnstone Park, a green pocket in the heart of the city

Healthcare and work in Geelong

Geelong's clinical offer is larger than its population suggests, for one simple reason: its main hospital is the only tertiary centre in Victoria outside Melbourne.

The region's principal referral hospital is a large public teaching hospital close to the city centre and the waterfront. It is the largest hospital in regional Victoria and the only one outside Melbourne with tertiary designation, providing emergency, intensive care, cardiac, cancer, maternity, paediatric, mental health and a broad range of specialist surgical and medical services.

Behind it sits a network of smaller hospitals and community health services across the Surf Coast, the Otways, Colac and the Bellarine, all referring inward for specialist and complex care. A new women's and children's hospital is being built in the city, a sign of how much the region is investing in its health services. Private hospitals and specialist imaging practices also operate in Geelong, giving clinicians a real choice of settings.



Tertiary-level work, with a team small enough to know each other's names

~350,000

primary catchment
and more for some
specialist services

1

tertiary hospital outside
Melbourne
in the whole of Victoria

1 hr

to Melbourne's
subspecialty centres
for the rarest cases

TERTIARY DESIGNATION

A metropolitan case mix

Genuine subspecialty exposure and complex work, with patients drawn from across the Barwon South West region.

DEAKIN UNIVERSITY

Teaching links

Close teaching relationships with Deakin's medical, nursing and health-science programmes, with opportunities to supervise and teach.

FULL-MODALITY SERVICE

Imaging and radiation

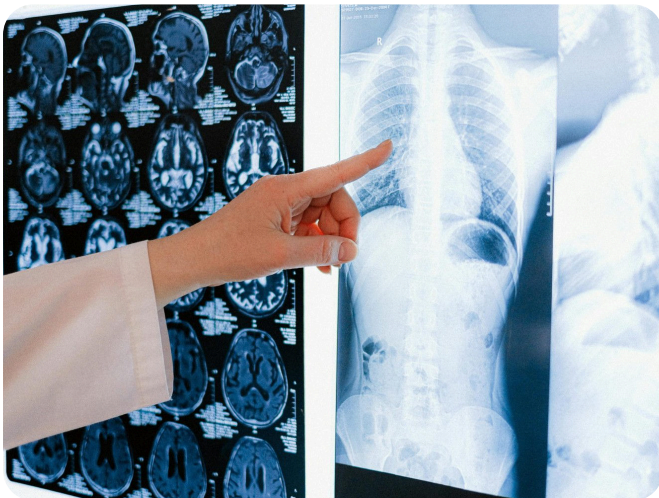
Regional Victoria's only tertiary imaging service, closer to a metropolitan department than a typical regional one, with cross-training actively supported.

VISIBILITY

Progression

Smaller specialist teams mean responsibility, leadership and senior roles tend to arrive earlier than in a large city.

Registration is national through Ahpra, but public-sector pay is set by Victorian enterprise agreements for each profession, so the same role can sit on a different scale in another state. In the private sector, pay is negotiated individually. We are always happy to explain how a specific role is graded before you decide anything.



Imaging is a particular strength of the regional service



Overseas-trained clinicians are a familiar and welcome part of the team

What to ask at interview

- ☐ How does the tertiary designation shape my day-to-day caseload?
- ☐ Which cases, if any, go to a Melbourne subspecialty service, and how involved do I stay?
- ☐ How many colleagues sit alongside me in my specialty specifically?
- ☐ What is the on-call pattern, and how often is it called upon?
- ☐ Which modalities or subspecialties would I be expected to cover?
- ☐ What CPD time and funding is available, including travel to Melbourne for courses?
- ☐ Is there a teaching component through Deakin, and how is it supported?



Care that is personal: in a regional service you often see patients through their whole journey

Where to live in Geelong

Geelong is compact enough that most commutes stay under twenty minutes, so you can choose on lifestyle rather than logistics. The real decision is inner city, the growing south, or the Bellarine.

~5-10 MIN · CAFÉS

Newtown & Geelong West

Leafy and established, with Pakington Street's cafés and shops on the doorstep. Lovely for walking to dinner; homes here are more compact for the money.

~10-15 MIN · VALUE

Herne Hill & Hamlyn Heights

A similar character a little further out, with more family-sized blocks and easy access to the city.

~10-15 MIN · FAMILIES

Highton & Wandana Heights

Established, green and family-friendly, close to well-regarded schools and the Barwon River trails.

~10-15 MIN · RIVER

Belmont & Grovedale

Popular southern suburbs near the Barwon River and the Waurin Ponds shopping and university precinct.

~20-25 MIN · NEWER HOMES

Armstrong Creek

The city's major growth area, with new, warm, well-insulated family homes, new schools and parks, and Torquay close by.

~25-35 MIN · SURF BEACHES

Ocean Grove & Barwon Heads

Relaxed beach towns at the mouth of the Barwon River, increasingly sought after by families who want the coast every day.

~20-35 MIN · THE BELLARINE

Drysdale, Leopold & Portarlington

Village life on the calmer bay side of the peninsula, among vineyards and farm gates.

~15-20 MIN · NORTH

Lara, Corio & Norlane

The city's more affordable northern suburbs, close to the ring road, the You Yangs and the Melbourne freeway, with ongoing renewal.

Almost everyone we help move here rents for six to twelve months before buying. It gives you time to learn which part of the city suits your family, your shifts and your weekends. Rentals on the Bellarine are most in demand over summer, so if you are drawn to the coast it helps to arrive with something secured for your first month.



Heritage shopfronts and independent shops in central Geelong



Eastern Beach, an easy walk or ride from the inner suburbs

Practical, in order

- ☐ Confirm your work site before you choose a suburb; most are close to the city centre, but some services are further out.
- ☐ Decide between inner city, the growing south, or the Bellarine.
- ☐ Rent for the first six to twelve months, and secure something before you fly.
- ☐ Check the school zone at the exact address using Find My School.
- ☐ If the Bellarine appeals, drive the commute at your real start time, ideally on a summer weekday.

Getting around Geelong

Most trips across Geelong take ten to twenty minutes, and it is the best train-connected regional city in Victoria, with Melbourne about an hour away.

ONE CARD

Myki

The same Myki card works on Geelong's local buses and on V/Line trains to Melbourne, so you can tap on across the whole network.

~1 HR TO MELBOURNE

V/Line trains

Frequent direct services to Southern Cross Station in the city, with local stations at South Geelong, North Shore, Wairn Ponds and more.

ACROSS THE CITY

Local buses

A network covering the suburbs, the Bellarine and the Surf Coast, with regional coaches further west along the coast.

FLAT AND SCENIC

Cycling

The waterfront and Barwon River trails make the inner city genuinely rideable on all but the windiest days.

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME	HOW
Across the city	10–20 min	Car or bus
Geelong → Torquay	~25 min	Car or bus
Geelong → Ocean Grove	~25 min	Car or bus
Geelong → Avalon Airport	~20 min	Car or airport shuttle
Geelong → Melbourne city centre	~1 hr	V/Line train or Princes Freeway
Geelong → Melbourne Airport	~1 hr	Car or airport shuttle
Geelong → Devonport, Tasmania	Overnight	Spirit of Tasmania ferry

A car makes life easier, especially at weekends, when the Bellarine, the Great Ocean Road and the wine regions are calling. But if you live centrally and work near the city centre, the train and buses can genuinely cover daily life, and many households here manage happily with one car rather than two. Parking is far easier than in Melbourne, and often free outside the city core.

Overseas licence holders can drive on their licence for a period after arriving, and convert to a Victorian licence through VicRoads if they stay longer than six months. Australians drive on the left.

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Tasmania from your doorstep

The Spirit of Tasmania now sails from Geelong to Devonport, with overnight crossings year-round and day sailings in the warmer months. Two new, larger ships are joining the route. Driving your own car onto the ferry for a Tasmanian holiday is a local favourite.



Flinders Street Station in Melbourne, about an hour from Geelong by train or freeway

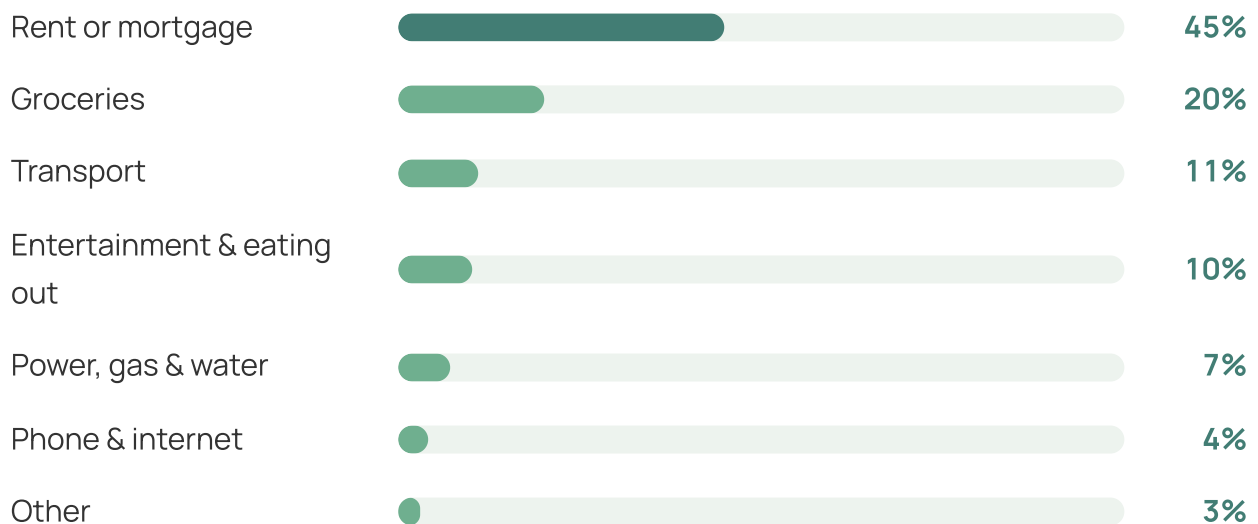
What it costs to live here

Think of Geelong as Melbourne prices for everyday life, with a noticeably more affordable roof over your head. Housing is where the difference really shows.

Groceries, fuel, insurance, power, phone and internet all sit close to Melbourne levels; Australia is largely a national market for these, and Geelong is big enough to have real competition between the major supermarkets. The change you will feel is in housing: renting or buying here costs materially less than in Melbourne, and Sydney is in a different league again.

What that means in practice is space. A family home with a garden, ten to twenty minutes from work, is a realistic goal on a clinical income in Geelong in a way it increasingly is not in the capital. Parking is easier and often free, and a shorter commute saves both time and fuel.

Where a month goes



Typical proportions for a household on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Housing is the biggest line, and it is where Geelong compares most favourably with Melbourne.

Worth planning for

- ✓ Coastal accommodation in summer. The Bellarine and Surf Coast see holiday pricing from Boxing Day to late January, worth knowing if you are house-hunting then.
- ✓ A car for weekends. The coast and wine country are best reached by car, so budget for one even if you commute by train.
- ✓ Winter warmth. Ask about insulation, heating and draught-proofing; a warm, efficient home keeps winter bills comfortable.
- ✓ The first-year set-up costs: visas and registration, flights, a rental bond, furniture and a car. These are the same wherever you land in Australia.



Life on the bay: the waterfront and marinas are free to enjoy every day

IN SHORT

- ✓ Everyday costs are close to Melbourne's; housing is where Geelong gives you more room.
- ✓ A family home with a garden and a short commute is a realistic goal here.
- ✓ Check current listings for the suburbs you like, and ask us how a role is graded before you budget.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Geelong

Geelong is the city I suggest when someone wants real, tertiary-level work but doesn't want the commute and the cost that come with a capital. The hospital here gives you a case mix you would normally travel to Melbourne for, and a team small enough that people know your name within weeks.

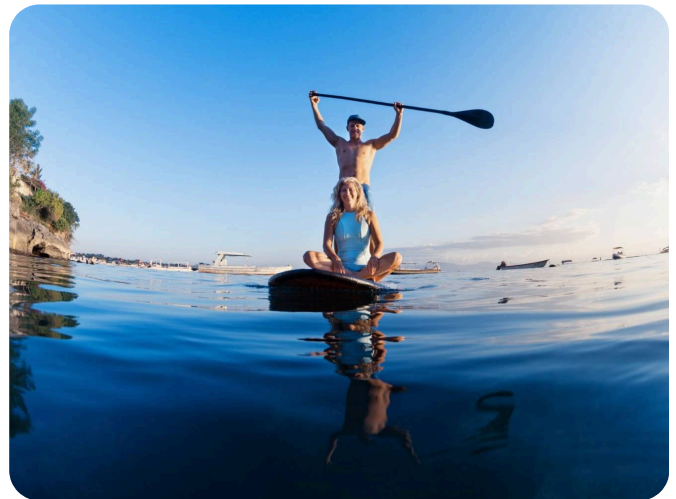
What I love about it is how naturally the coast becomes part of everyday life. People tell me about swimming at Eastern Beach after a shift, Saturday mornings on Pako and Sunday drives down the Great Ocean Road, and Melbourne is still there for a concert or a match whenever you want it. If you're drawn to that balance, I'd encourage you to come and take a look.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Shared tables and new friends: Geelong is easy to settle into



Calm-water days are made for a paddle

Food, shopping and the everyday

Geelong eats well for a city its size, and one street does a lot of the work. An ordinary week here has a pleasant shape: short commutes, light evenings and Saturday mornings with somewhere to be.

"PAKO" · GEELONG WEST & NEWTOWN

Pakington Street

The café and shopping strip locals simply call Pako. Great coffee, bakeries and casual dining, and where people actually spend a Saturday morning.

DINNER OUT

Little Malop Street & the waterfront

Restaurants and bars in the city centre and along the water, with views across Corio Bay included.

EVERY SATURDAY

Geelong City Market

Seasonal produce, artisan goods and street food in the city centre, alongside farmers' markets across the region.

20-30 MIN

Wine on the doorstep

The Bellarine Peninsula and Moorabool Valley are cool-climate pinot noir and chardonnay country, with welcoming cellar doors.

Geelong is more international than many people expect. Around one in five residents was born overseas, with the UK, India, New Zealand and the Philippines leading the list, and Punjabi is one of the most common languages spoken at home after English. You will find Indian, South Asian and Asian grocers in Geelong West and Belmont, a mosque, a Sikh gurdwara and a Hindu temple, an active Malayalee association with a big Onam celebration each year, and Filipino, Nepalese and Bengali community festivals.

For anything more specialised, Melbourne's markets and cultural precincts are an hour away, and many families enjoy a monthly trip to stock up.



Coffee culture on Pako is a genuine local pleasure



Flavours from home are easy to find in Geelong



Cool-climate wine country is twenty minutes from the city

A week, once you have settled in

- ✓ Weekdays: a short commute, and light enough in the evening for a walk along the waterfront before dinner.
- ✓ Saturday afternoon: Eastern Beach or the Bellarine coast if the wind is kind, a Moorabool Valley cellar door if it isn't.
- ✓ Saturday morning: coffee and errands on Pako, or the city market.
- ✓ Sunday: the Great Ocean Road for a proper day out, or the Barwon River trails close to home.

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Finding your people

Geelong is big enough for real variety and small enough that joining something is a fast way in: a football or netball club, a surf lifesaving club, a church or temple, or a community association. Cultura, the city's multicultural service, is a friendly first stop for newcomers. It's a Cats town, too: expect the whole city to talk football in September.



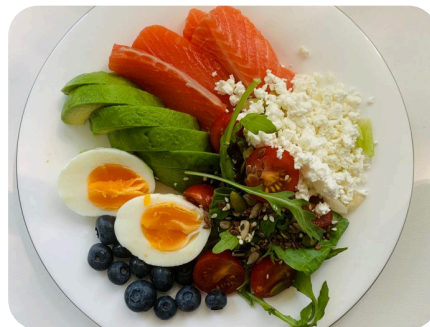
Kirtan at a Melbourne gurdwara, an hour away; Geelong has its own gurdwara too



Asian grocers and restaurants make favourite dishes easy to cook or find



Sushi is an everyday lunch in Australia



Fresh produce from the region's farm gates



Smashed avocado on toast: a café classic

What people do at the weekend

You are living at the start of one of the world's great coastal drives, with a capital city on the other side of you. Weekends here practically plan themselves.

~25 MIN

Torquay & Bells Beach

The official start of the Great Ocean Road and the home of Australian surfing. Gentle beaches for beginners and families, and close enough for a weeknight swim.

~25-30 MIN

Ocean Grove & Barwon Heads

Family beach towns at the mouth of the Barwon River, with patrolled surf beaches and a calm river for paddling.

~35 MIN

Queenscliff

A heritage seaside town with grand old hotels, and a car ferry across the bay to Sorrento on the Mornington Peninsula.



Summer evenings on the waterfront



Cunningham Pier, a favourite spot for a waterfront stroll



Learning to surf is an easy weekend habit when the coast is twenty-five minutes away

~30 MIN

Portarlington

A relaxed bay-side town known for its mussels, with a ferry link to Geelong and Melbourne.

~20-40 MIN

The Bellarine wineries

Cool-climate cellar doors, farm gates and a well-marked taste trail across the peninsula.

~ 30 MIN

The You Yangs

A granite range with walking and mountain-bike trails, and views back over Corio Bay and, on a clear day, to Melbourne.

In the city itself

- ✓ A walk or swim at Eastern Beach, with its art deco bathing pavilion and enclosed swimming area.
- ✓ Kardinia Park on an AFL match day.
- ✓ The Geelong Gallery, the library and Heritage Centre, and the National Wool Museum.
- ✓ The waterfront carousel, the Ferris wheel in summer and the painted Baywalk bollards.
- ✓ The Barwon River trails for cycling, running and rowing.
- ✓ A Saturday on Pakington Street.



A sacred kingfisher: birdwatching is a quiet joy on the river trails and in the bush



Brighton's bathing boxes in Melbourne, an easy day trip

Around Geelong

Geelong is not just near the coast; it is where the coast starts. Within a few hours you have the Great Ocean Road, Melbourne, wine and spa country, the Victorian Alps and even Tasmania by sea.

The **Great Ocean Road** begins at Torquay and runs for over two hundred kilometres along the Southern Ocean: surf beaches, the café town of Lorne, rainforest and waterfalls in the Otways behind Apollo Bay, koalas in the trees at Kennett River and, finally, the limestone stacks of the Twelve Apostles. From Geelong it is a long day trip, or better still an overnight, and most people do it many times.

Melbourne is an hour up the freeway or the train line: the restaurants and laneways, the MCG, the galleries and the concerts are all an easy day or evening out. In winter, the **Victorian Alps** make a wonderful snow trip, and the **Spirit of Tasmania** sails from Geelong itself, so a Tasmanian road trip starts with a night on the ferry.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Eastern Beach (in the city)	~5 min	The nearest beach: calm bay water, an enclosed swimming area, lawns and a playground on the waterfront.
Torquay & Bells Beach	~25 min	The nearest surf beaches and the start of the Great Ocean Road.
Avalon Airport	~20 min	Domestic flights from the edge of the city.
Melbourne Airport	~1 hr	Direct international flights across Asia, the Middle East and beyond.
Melbourne	~1 hr	The nearest city and state capital: food, culture, sport and Melbourne's subspecialty services.
Queenscliff & the Bellarine	~35 min	Heritage seaside towns, wineries and the ferry to the Mornington Peninsula.
Lorne & the Otways	~1 hr 15	Rainforest walks, waterfalls and a lovely beach town.
The Twelve Apostles	~3 hrs	The Great Ocean Road's most famous view; best as an overnight.
Mt Buller & the Victorian Alps	~3 hrs 30–4 hrs	The nearest major ski fields, with a season of roughly June to September, snow permitting. Lake Mountain is closer for a first day in the snow.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Devonport, Tasmania	Overnight ferry	The Spirit of Tasmania sails from Geelong: take your car and explore Tasmania.

FROM ~25 MIN

The Great Ocean Road

Surf at Torquay, lunch at Lorne, rainforest in the Otways and the Twelve Apostles at sunset.

~1 HR 15–1 HR 30

Ballarat & Daylesford

Gold-rush streetscapes, Sovereign Hill for the children, and spa country with mineral springs and lakes.

~1 HR

Lerderderg & the bush

Gorges, river walks and forest trails in the state parks to the north.

~3 HRS 30+

The High Country

Snow in winter; rivers, rail trails and historic towns in summer.



The Twelve Apostles at sunset, at the far end of the Great Ocean Road



Melbourne's Southbank, about an hour from Geelong



A historic town in Victoria's High Country, on the way to the Alps



Bushwalking in the Lerderderg area, about an hour north



Kangaroos are a common sight at the You Yangs and in the state parks



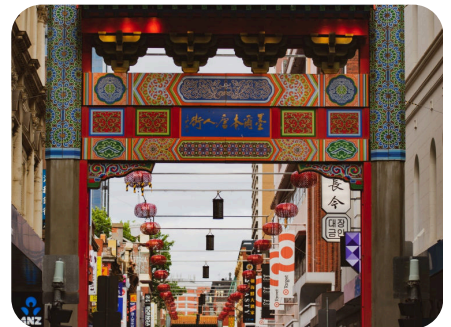
Melbourne's laneway street art, about an hour from Geelong



Victorian terraces in inner Melbourne



The Yarra Valley wine region, on Melbourne's far side



Melbourne's Chinatown, the oldest in Australia

Families and schools

Geelong is a lovely place to grow up: beaches and bike paths, sport for every age, short school runs, and a school system with plenty of choice.



After the bell: short school runs are one of the joys of a city this size



Victoria funds kindergarten for three- and four-year-olds

Victorian children start school in **Prep**, the year they turn five by the end of April, then move through primary school (Prep to Year 6) and secondary school (Years 7 to 12), finishing with the Victorian Certificate of Education (VCE) or the VCE Vocational Major. The school year runs from late January to December in four terms.

Most children attend **government schools**, which allocate places by address through school zones. Alongside them are **Catholic** schools, with modest fees, and **independent** schools. Geelong has some long-established independent schools, including Geelong Grammar School at Corio and The Geelong College in Newtown, as well as Christian, Lutheran and international colleges across the city.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Check the school zone at the exact address before you sign a lease, using the Victorian Government's Find My School tool.
- ☐ Visit, or ask for a video call. Principals here are used to international families and are happy to talk.
- ☐ Ask about English as an Additional Language support and how new arrivals are welcomed.
- ☐ Uniforms are bought from the school's uniform shop or its appointed supplier; several Geelong uniform stores supply many schools at once.



School fees on a temporary visa

Victoria generally does not charge tuition fees at government schools for the children of skilled temporary visa holders, such as the subclass 482 and 494, though some other temporary visas do pay. Check your exact visa with the Victorian Department of Education's International Education Division before you enrol.

What children tend to love here



Eastern Beach, with its enclosed swimming area, playground and the waterfront carousel.



Auskick, the junior Australian rules football programme, plus netball, cricket, soccer and Little Athletics.



Adventure Park in summer, the You Yangs, and a first day in the snow.



Learning to surf at Torquay or Ocean Grove, and Nippers at the local surf lifesaving club.



Riding the Barwon River trails and the Bellarine Rail Trail.



Days out in Melbourne: the zoo, Scienceworks and the museum.



Early childhood

Victoria's Free Kinder programme funds kindergarten for three- and four-year-olds at participating services, and long day care is widely available, with the Australian Government's Child Care Subsidy helping eligible families with the cost.

WATERFRONT & WAURN PONDS

Deakin University

Two Geelong campuses, including a School of Medicine and strong nursing, health and engineering programmes.

TAFE

The Gordon

Geelong's TAFE institute, with health, nursing, community services and trades courses.



Learning to surf is a rite of passage for Geelong children



Holiday programmes and water sports keep school holidays busy



Creative play is at the heart of early learning



Spotting koalas in the wild is a highlight for children



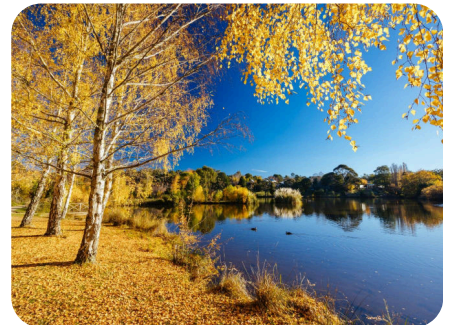
Camping weekends are a classic Australian family holiday



Fresh, colourful food everywhere



Canola in flower across Victoria's farmland in spring



Autumn at Lake Daylesford, about an hour and a half away

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Geelong suits clinicians who want tertiary work and the coast, and gives them both in the same week.

Your Geelong address book

Geelong is more multicultural than many newcomers expect: around one in five residents was born overseas, with the UK, India, New Zealand and the Philippines the largest groups. Cultura, the city's multicultural organisation, links almost fifty community groups, and there is an active Malayalee association, a Syro-Malabar mission, a gurdwara, a Hindu temple and a mosque, with Melbourne's wider communities an hour away.

COUNCILS & LOCAL SERVICES

City of Greater Geelong

Rubbish collection, libraries, pools, parks, kindergarten registration and community services

03 5272 5272 geelongaustralia.com.au

Borough of Queenscliffe

Council for Queenscliff and Point Lonsdale

queenscliffe.vic.gov.au

Surf Coast Shire

Council for Torquay, Jan Juc, Anglesea and Lorne

surfcoast.vic.gov.au

Public Transport Victoria

Journey planner, timetables and Myki for Geelong buses and V/Line trains

ptv.vic.gov.au

NURSE-ON-CALL

Free 24-hour health advice from a registered nurse, anywhere in Victoria

1300 60 60 24

VicEmergency

Fire danger ratings, total fire bans and emergency warnings; worth downloading the app

emergency.vic.gov.au

GETTING TO KNOW THE PLACE

Visit Geelong & the Bellarine

The official visitor site: events, markets, food, wineries and things to do

visitgeelongbellarine.com.au

Cultura

Geelong's multicultural organisation: settlement support, English classes and community groups

03 4210 0000 cultura.org.au

Spirit of Tasmania

The car and passenger ferry from Geelong to Devonport

spiritoftasmania.com.au

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Cultura (formerly Diversitat)

Geelong's multicultural organisation and main settlement provider for new arrivals: settlement support, English classes, community programmes and the PakoFesta multicultural festival; links almost fifty affiliated community groups

03 4210 0000 cultura.org.au

Greater Geelong Malayalee Association (GGMA)

The Malayalee and Kerala community association for Geelong, formed in 2011; runs a Grand Onam celebration each year and family cultural events

ggma.org.au

Indian Association of Geelong

Indian community association for the region, working towards a purpose-built community centre for Diwali, Holi, language classes and family events

Filipino Australian Friendship Association of Geelong (FAFAG)

Filipino community association; runs Pasko sa Geelong, a Filipino Christmas celebration, and community events

fafag.au

Geelong Nepalese Association

Nepalese community association; runs a regional Holi and Nepali New Year festival

gna.org.au

Association of Bengalis in Geelong

Bengali community group; holds an annual Durga Puja

Sri Lankan, Nigerian and Irish community groups

Sri Lankan, Nigerian, Irish and Scottish community groups are among Cultura's affiliated communities; Cultura can put you in touch

cultura.org.au

Wathaurong Aboriginal Co-operative

Aboriginal community-controlled organisation for the Geelong region

wathaurong.org.au

City of Greater Geelong: Multicultural Geelong

Council information for multicultural communities, including the community directory of local groups and clubs

geelongaustralia.com.au

FACEBOOK GROUPS

Greater Geelong Malayalee Association on Facebook

Onam tickets, event dates and community notices for Geelong's Malayalee families

facebook.com/geelongmalayalee

PLACES OF WORSHIP

St Mary of the Angels Basilica

Catholic basilica and parish in central Geelong, Yarra Street

stmarysgeelong.com.au

St Sebastian's Syro-Malabar Mission

Syro-Malabar Catholic mission for Geelong's Kerala community, with Holy Qurbana at St Margaret's Church, 46 Lomond Terrace, East Geelong, and faith formation classes for children

syromalabar.org.au/geelong

Christ Church Geelong

Historic Anglican church on Moorabool Street, the oldest Anglican church in Victoria still in use on its original site

christchurchgeelong.com.au

Hillsong Church Geelong

Pentecostal church in Geelong West

Geelong Gateway Church

Pentecostal church (Australian Christian Churches) in Moolap

Orthodox churches

Greek Orthodox (Hamlyn Heights), Serbian, Ukrainian and Russian Orthodox (Bell Park) and Macedonian Orthodox (Batesford) parishes serve the city's long-established communities

Geelong Mosque

Mosque in Manifold Heights, run by the Islamic Society of Geelong; holds regular open days for the wider community. Deakin University also has a musalla at Wearn Ponds

Geelong Shiv Temple

Hindu temple in Marshall, in the city's south

Geelong Gurudwara Sahib

Sikh gurdwara at Lovely Banks, in the city's north

Wat Samphanthawong

Thai Buddhist temple in Lara

Jewish community

Geelong has no active synagogue today; Melbourne's large Jewish community, centred on Caulfield and St Kilda, is about an hour away

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Geelong West Indian Grocery

Indian, Pakistani and Bangladeshi groceries at 64 Elizabeth Street, Geelong West, with delivery

03 5229 2748

Murugan Indian Grocery

Indian and South Asian groceries at 4 Arthur Street, Belmont

03 5241 3237

Just Spice

Spices and Indian groceries at 168 Moorabool Street, central Geelong

03 5222 4451

Indo-Asian Grocery

Indian and Asian groceries in Belmont

facebook.com/IndoAsianGroceries

Islamic Council of Victoria

State Muslim peak body, with community and halal information across Victoria

icv.org.au

Kosher Australia

Kosher certification body with a searchable list of certified products, many stocked in mainstream supermarkets

kosher.org.au

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Woolworths

National supermarket chain with stores across Geelong and the Bellarine

woolworths.com.au

Coles

National supermarket chain with stores across Geelong and the Bellarine

coles.com.au

ALDI

Discount supermarket with a smaller, good-value range

aldi.com.au

IGA

Independent supermarkets, including several family-run stores around Geelong

iga.com.au

Geelong City Market

Weekly market every Saturday in Market Square Mall on Little Malop Street: seasonal produce, artisan goods and street food

South Geelong Farmers' Market

Farmers' market on the first and third Sunday of each month

Bellarine Farmers' Market

Farmers' market in Ocean Grove on the third Saturday of each month

Visit Geelong & the Bellarine: markets

Up-to-date guide to farmers', community and makers' markets across the region

visitgeelongbellarine.com.au

SCHOOLS & UNIFORMS

Find My School

Victorian Government tool to find your zoned government school by address

findmyschool.vic.gov.au

Victorian Department of Education

School enrolment, Free Kinder and, through its International Education Division, fee rules for students on temporary visas

education.vic.gov.au

School uniforms

Bought from each school's uniform shop or its appointed supplier; the school will tell you which

Bellarine Uniforms (Noone)

Uniform store at 162 Moorabool Street, Geelong, supplying more than thirty local schools

03 5221 9199

PSW

School uniform supplier with stores across Victoria and online click-and-collect for many schools

psw.com.au

State Schools' Relief

Charity that helps families in need with uniforms and essentials, arranged through the school
stateschoolsrelief.org.au

HOUSING & AREAS

realestate.com.au

The largest rental and sales listings site
realestate.com.au

Domain

Rental and sales listings, with suburb profiles
domain.com.au

Flatmates.com.au

Rooms and house shares, handy for your first few months
flatmates.com.au

Residential Tenancies Bond Authority

Where your rental bond is lodged and held; check and claim it online
rentalbonds.vic.gov.au

Consumer Affairs Victoria

Renting rules, minimum standards and your rights as a tenant
consumer.vic.gov.au

Tenants Victoria

Not-for-profit advice and information for renters
tenantsvic.org.au

GETTING AROUND

Public Transport Victoria

Journey planner, timetables, Myki and fares for Geelong buses and V/Line trains
ptv.vic.gov.au

V/Line

Regional trains between Geelong and Melbourne, and coaches along the coast
vline.com.au

VicRoads

Driver licences, registration and converting an overseas licence (required if you stay more than six months)
vicroads.vic.gov.au

Avalon Airport

Geelong's local airport, about twenty minutes from the city
avalonairport.com.au

Spirit of Tasmania

Car and passenger ferry from Geelong to Devonport
spiritoftasmania.com.au

Port Phillip Ferries

Bay ferries linking Geelong and Portarlington with Docklands in Melbourne
portphillipferries.com.au

COST COMPARISON LINKS

Numbeo: Geelong

Crowd-sourced cost-of-living figures; compare Geelong with the city you are leaving
numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Geelong

Victorian Energy Compare

Official Victorian Government site for comparing electricity and gas offers
compare.energy.vic.gov.au

Australian Bureau of Statistics

Official price and consumer price index data
abs.gov.au



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
000

Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
mara.gov.au

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 ahpra.gov.au

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

MONEY & HOME

Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
13 28 61 ato.gov.au

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

SETTLING IN

TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
131 450 tisnational.gov.au

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Geelong. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

hello@ethicareresourcing.com · +44 7375 019544 · ethicareresourcing.com

One Coldbath Square, London EC1R 5HL · Company No. 14646354